

Ian Cowpar

PM building at principal scope | AI-first product workflows | platform infrastructure | zero-translation systems

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SUMMARY

Product manager who builds platform-internal systems that reduce cognitive load for the engineers and PMs running on top of them. I find the manual, repeated work — feedback synthesis, defect triage, status reporting — and replace it with AI-assisted workflows that compound at the team level rather than depending on me staying in the room. At UKG I owned a product representing \$250M ARR: scaling a PM automation library into shared team capability, designing a five-panel defect triage system across four products with a Claude Code function I built into the tool surfacing the highest-leverage action per panel, and building sprint health instrumentation refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams — all of it built for signal, not ceremony.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR | Platform infrastructure, AI-first PM workflows, and team adoption

- Built a PM automation library then scaled it into a team-wide AI capability layer — the first organized AI adoption effort within the product org. Designed from the start as shared infrastructure rather than personal tooling; adoption spread without a top-down mandate.
- Designed a five-panel defect triage system classifying open issues across customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise; auto-refreshed daily across four products, with a Claude Code function I built into the tool surfacing the highest-leverage action per panel. Replaced manual feedback synthesis with a workflow the team runs without me.
- Designed sprint health instrumentation refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection of burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns — each with technical rationale. Built to reduce the cognitive load on the engineers it reported on, not to manufacture status updates.
- Led ARR-focused risk tracking for the UTA upgrade program: automated weekly reporting routes every open blocker to the program lead; live tracking surfaces aging issues before escalation.
- Led product definition and UX for a migration tool now in active production; rebuilt it as a self-service flow so the Services org runs migrations without an engineering ticket — removing the primary friction point between licensing the platform and actually using it.
- Served as the product-side voice on direct enterprise customer calls — escalation and pre-upgrade sessions — synthesizing what customers actually needed versus what was on the roadmap and feeding that gap back into prioritization decisions.

Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026 | Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments in a compliance-grade environment across the full delivery lifecycle; developed strong instincts for how teams adopt new tooling, where onboarding stalls, and what separates a successful activation from shelfware.
- Became internal SME for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full client base; translated complex product capabilities into workflows that non-technical users could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Product: Platform PM, product infrastructure, MVP definition, end-to-end delivery, B2B SaaS, enterprise and SMB, developer-experience-adjacent activation flows

AI and Systems: AI-first product workflows, prompt engineering, agentic systems, generative AI for customer feedback synthesis, Claude Code, PM automation, zero-translation building

Data & Analytics: KPI definition, metrics instrumentation, automated reporting cadence, qualitative-to-structured synthesis, A/B experimentation

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption, unofficial leadership, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product, AI adoption, and team dynamics.